

SMARTPHONES

WHAT'S THE SMART CHOICE?



All the smarts you need when buying a smartphone

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The global smartphone industry is experiencing a maturation phase, with growth settling after a period of rapid expansion. Analyst firm Morgan Stanley predicts India's smartphone market to triple by 2032, reaching \$90 billion and becoming the world's third-largest after China and the US. On a global scale, artificial intelligence (AI) is taking centre stage in the smartphone industry. And this trend is not going anywhere. As AI and 5G become more pervasive, the smartphone industry is poised to evolve significantly. There is an abundance of choices, that can make selecting the right phone challenging. To simplify this process, we've created a cheat sheet to help you identify the best options for their needs. Read on!

BUDGET SMARTPHONES (UNDER ₹20,000)

In 2024, the Indian market has seen a massive surge in budget-friendly options. Brands like Motorola, Xiaomi, realme, iQOO, and POCO have released models that offer a balance between performance and affordability. The trend towards 5G connectivity has also been embraced. However, some features will remain elusive at this price point; the important thing is to figure out what's non-negotiable.

These are the features you should look for:

- **High Battery Life** – While the sub-₹20,000 price segment may not have the strongest SoCs, what they do have are robust phones with long-lasting battery life, mainly because the processors aren't too power-hungry. Ensure that you check reviews to understand how long-lasting a phone's battery is.
- **5G Connectivity** – Once a premium feature, 5G connectivity is not a non-negotiable for most people. The sub-₹20,000 price segment is brimming with 5G options, however, it is prudent to check how many 5G bands a phone supports and whether the bands supported by the phone are available in India.
- **RAM and Storage** – Gone are the days of 2 GB + 32 GB phones. Even in the sub-₹20,000 segment, ensure that you look for at least 6 GB RAM in order to multitask without a hitch. As for storage, go for anything above 128 GB to future-proof your purchase, and also attempt to look for phones with expandable storage.

MID-RANGE SMARTPHONES (₹20,000 TO ₹40,000)

Mid-range smartphones are undeniably the most exciting in the Indian market in the current landscape. OEMs are packing

these phones with nearly-flagship-grade specifications and features. Mid-range phones between ₹20-40K provide the most bang for your buck, almost rendering high-end phones useless. So, to that end, here are some features that you must look for:

- **Powerful Processors** - Mid-range phones are some of the most powerful phones on the block right now. In the ₹20-30K segment, look for powerful processors such as the MediaTek Dimensity 7200 or the Dimensity 8200, the Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3, and even the powerful Snapdragon 8s Gen 3. In the ₹30-40K price bracket, you can even get your hands on phones with last year's flagship chipsets.
- **AMOLED displays** - A fantastic display is a non-negotiable. Not only should you look for a bright AMOLED display, but you should also ensure that they support HDR10+ or Dolby Atmos. At this price, you could even get some phones with LTPO panels which will go a long way in preserving your phone's battery.
- **Fast Charging** - Do not consider any phone in the ₹20-40K price segment without fast charging, nothing under 45 W. A few Samsung phones still offer 25 W but the norm at this price point is 67 W and above, which will ensure that your phone is fully charged in under an hour.